

Tobias Treppmann

A design leader who still builds

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Craft and building

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · SwiftUI · React and web · Claude Code, Cursor and Zed as daily tools · Selah, a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Visual and interaction quality

DTCG tokens in four tiers synced live to Figma and Android · checks in CI that refuse off-system work · WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm · custom motion easing curves

Leading and coaching designers

Nine reports across four disciplines at Ninox, on the senior leadership team · hired two, promoted two · ten years as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry, two at the Interaction Design Foundation

Research and analytics

Conversion and usage metrics · interviews recorded and analyzed with Claude · competitive analysis of the global apps entering a market · usertesting.com screening to reach hard-to-recruit users

PROFILE

I lead design functions and I never stopped building. At Ninox I ran design and, for four months, product as well: nine people across design, UX writing, product and data science. The last year has been deliberately hands-on. The quality bar lives in the build, not in the review.

iOS, Android, web, CTV

UI quality owned across all four today — held by tokens, so one commit propagates to every platform

Engineering ships my code

prototypes built in real code against real production APIs — a handoff that crosses a company boundary and holds anyway

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- I prototype in code, not in specs — real code against real production APIs. Engineering ships from it.
- A quality bar the build enforces — six checks, identical on a laptop and in CI. They refuse work that has left the system, so review time goes to the things a check cannot see.
- UI quality across four surfaces — iOS, Android, web and connected TV, held by DTCG tokens in four tiers. One commit propagates everywhere.
- A color engine in OKLCH — k-means clustering rather than RGB, so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight. WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm.
- Improving an existing product, not restarting it — conversion and usage data read against the category's market leaders, and the redesign in development now refines what that audit found weakest.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Booking capability, embedded rather than bolted on — the internal plan was a standalone add-on; I argued for building it into the platform and delivered it that way. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance, then shipped to every customer.
- Accessibility past our own front door — the audit covered our website and every site customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance.
- Product management and all of product design at once — across six countries I wrote the specs and ran the ticket board engineering worked from.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — Product Design and Product held together, July to October 2023. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — and coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense interfaces — pivot tables, aggregated JSON views, result cards, filter logic. The hardest was the query-builder preview, where the result is a sample.
- Research as a habit, not an event — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach analysts working inside regulated banks and insurers.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce, hundreds of thousands of consumers — 200+ people) · Leipzig, Germany

- Research that changed a consumer product's direction — leadership wanted a 60-second automated journey. Shop owners valued the design step most. The strategy moved, and the mobile prototype went to production.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA